AHEAD WITH KK

Make your first customers visible: a guide for new or quiet businesses

for new shops, food counters, salons, clinics, online sellers

What I saw. In a Bangalore mall food court, one burrito counter had a long queue. The counter next door, same floor, same crowd, had a chef waiting. My take: people don't only pick the food. They pick the queue.

1. Show real customers

- Photos of real buyers (with their OK) on your counter, your Instagram and your Google listing.

2. Put reviews up front

- Your best 3 Google reviews printed near the door, on the menu, and in your WhatsApp reply.

3. Bunch your customers

- A queue is a signal. Rather than 10 people spread over a day, run a "fresh at 7 pm" batch, a weekly trial day, or a launch hour, so people see others choosing you.

4. Look busy from outside

- Lights on, staff active, something being made in view. An idle counter reads as "nobody chose this".

5. Ask every happy customer for one thing

- A review, a photo, a tag. Make it easy: a QR code at billing.

6. Don't fake it

- No paid fake reviews or staged queues. Customers notice, and it can break platform rules.

Practical steps, not guaranteed results.